



Manual Tester vs Automation Tester

Manual Tester (Functional Tester)	Automation Tester
Understands business requirements and user stories.	Understands business requirements, automation framework, and application flow.
Prepares Test Scenarios and Manual Test Cases.	Identifies stable test cases suitable for automation.
Performs Smoke Testing.	Automates and executes Smoke Test Suites.
Performs Sanity Testing.	Automates and executes Sanity Test Suites.
Performs Functional Testing manually.	Develops automation scripts using tools like Playwright, Selenium, Cypress, etc.
Performs Exploratory Testing.	Focuses on automated execution rather than exploratory testing.
Finds application defects through manual testing.	Finds defects through automated execution.
Reports bugs in defect tracking tools (Jira, Azure DevOps, etc.).	Reports automation failures and application defects.
Verifies bug fixes manually.	Re-runs automation scripts after bug fixes.
Executes Manual Regression Testing when required.	Executes the Automation Regression Suite.
Validates UI, functionality, and business logic from an end-user perspective.	Validates application functionality using automation scripts.
Programming knowledge is optional (basic scripting is helpful).	Programming knowledge is mandatory (Java, TypeScript, Python, C#, etc.).
Focuses on application quality and user experience.	Focuses on automation, regression coverage, speed, and repeatability.
Mainly responsible for finding functional issues in new features.	Mainly responsible for maintaining automation scripts and ensuring continuous regression testing.
Works closely with Business Analysts, Developers, and Product Owners.	Works closely with Developers, DevOps Engineers, and Manual Testers.
Delivers manual test execution reports.	Delivers automation execution reports and test results.
Best suited for ad-hoc, usability, and exploratory testing.	Best suited for repetitive, regression, smoke, sanity, and data-driven testing.